

James Russo

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SUMMARY

Gameplay & XR Designer focused on building and refining game-driven, user-facing experiences across Unity, Unreal Engine, web, and XR. Experienced in rapid prototyping, hands-on testing, and iterative improvement, with a strong eye for interaction quality and usability. Collaborative, detail-oriented, and motivated by shipping polished, engaging immersive experiences that feel good to use.

SKILLS

- **Game Engines:** Unreal Engine (Blueprints) and Unity
- **Programming Languages:** C# and JavaScript
- **Gameplay & XR:** VR/MR development for Meta Quest and Apple Vision Pro
- **QA & Optimization:** Usability testing, bug reproduction, and regression testing
- **Interaction Design:** User flows, wireframing, and rapid prototyping
- **Design Software:** Figma and Adobe Creative Cloud (XD, Photoshop)
- **Web & UI:** HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and jQuery
- **Mobile & Tools:** Swift & SwiftUI (Foundational); Git/GitHub

EXPERIENCE

Apple Inc. — Boise Towne Square, Boise, ID

Technical Specialist

Jul 2026 – Present

- Manage frontline diagnostics and initial triage at the Genius Bar, prioritizing efficient software and ecosystem resolution
- Perform hands-on troubleshooting for iOS, account configuration, and device data migration while educating customers on product functionality
- Resolve on-site software and settings issues and coordinate escalations to the hardware repair team for complex servicing

Apple Retail Specialist

Aug 2025 – Jul 2026

- Translate user needs into tailored technical solutions through hands-on demos and guided onboarding
- Diagnose and resolve hardware and software issues while clearly communicating root cause and resolution

Lead Interaction Designer

Jan 2023 – Jan 2024

Boise State University · Freelance

- Led interaction design for a student-facing personal finance web app, ensuring a user-centered approach from concept to delivery
- Developed user flows, wireframes, and high-fidelity UI prioritizing clarity, accessibility, and ease of use in collaboration with a small cross-functional team

EDUCATION

B.S., Games, Interactive Media & Mobile Technologies

Aug 2021 – Dec 2025

Boise State University — Boise, ID

CERTIFICATES

- **Unreal Engine Fundamentals** | Epic Games (April 2026)
- **Introduction to Game Design** | Epic Games (January 2026)
- **XR Developer (Program Certificate)** | Boise State University, GIMM (May 2025)
- **Learn How to Make a Fighting Game in Unreal Engine** | Unreal University (August–November 2024)